a halloween counting game · ages 3–5

the apprentice wizards' magic potion

brew a bubbling potion by counting out the right number of spooky ingredients.



how to play

1. **Give each wizard a potion mat.** Spread the ingredient tokens in a tray where everyone can reach.
2. **Draw a recipe card.** Each card is a list of ingredients with a number shown on dice.
3. **Read, count, and add.** Count the dice, then place that many of each ingredient on your potion.
4. **Check your brew.** Count again and match it to the card — your potion is ready!
5. **Play again.** Tip the ingredients back and draw a new recipe.

read the dice

Every number is shown as dice dots. Count the dots to know how many to add. Big numbers (7–10) use **two dice** — count all the dots together.



the spooky ingredients

- spider web
- eyeball
- maggot
- pumpkin
- bone

two levels

Level 1 — numbers 1 to 6 with four ingredients: spider web, eyeball, maggot and pumpkin.
Level 2 — numbers 1 to 10 adds a fifth ingredient: bones.

play together (2 players)

One child is the **witch** and reads the ingredients aloud; the other adds them to the potion. Then check the brew together against the card.

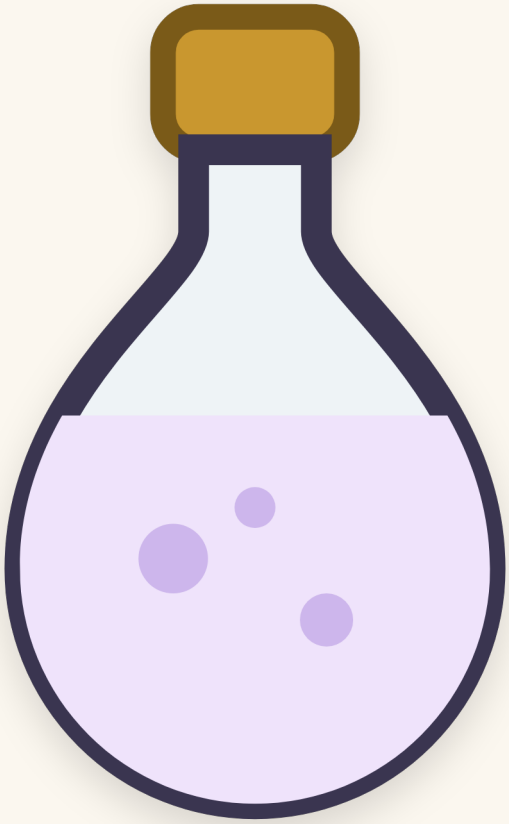
what children practise: counting collections to 10 · reading dice · number words · one-to-one matching · fine motor & hand–eye control

what to print 1× potion mat per child · the recipe cards for your level · the ingredient-token sheets (print several copies for a group). Laminate for repeat play.

my magic potion

potion mat

Place your ingredients on the potion. Count carefully — add exactly the number on your recipe card!



drop your ingredients in the brew

spider web · eyeball · maggot · pumpkin · bone

recipe cards — level 1 (1 to 6)

dice series

recipe #1










recipe #2










recipe #3










recipe #4










recipe cards — level 1 (1 to 6)

dice series

recipe #5










recipe #6










recipe #7










recipe #8










recipe cards — level 2 (1 to 10)

dice series

recipe #1












recipe #2












recipe #3












recipe #4







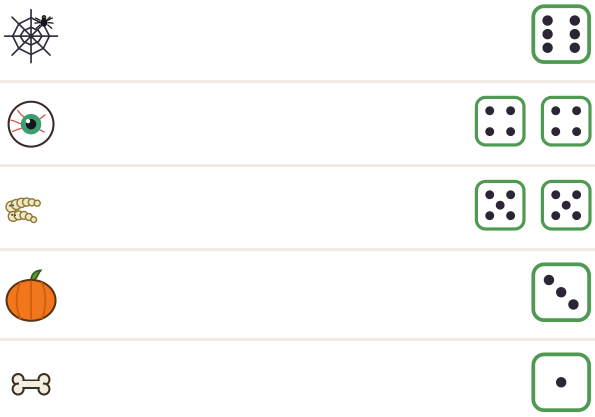




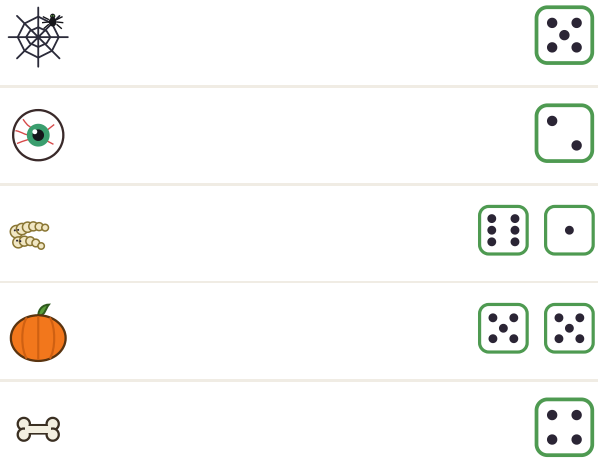

recipe cards — level 2 (1 to 10)

dice series

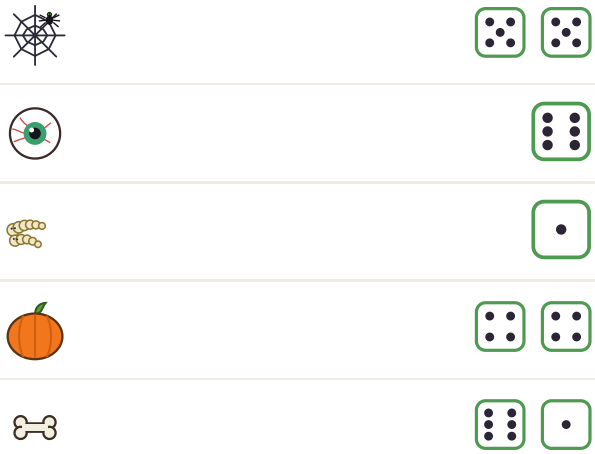
recipe #5



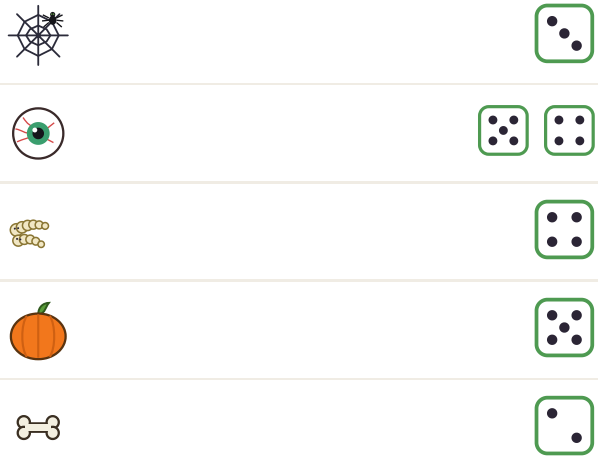
recipe #6



recipe #7



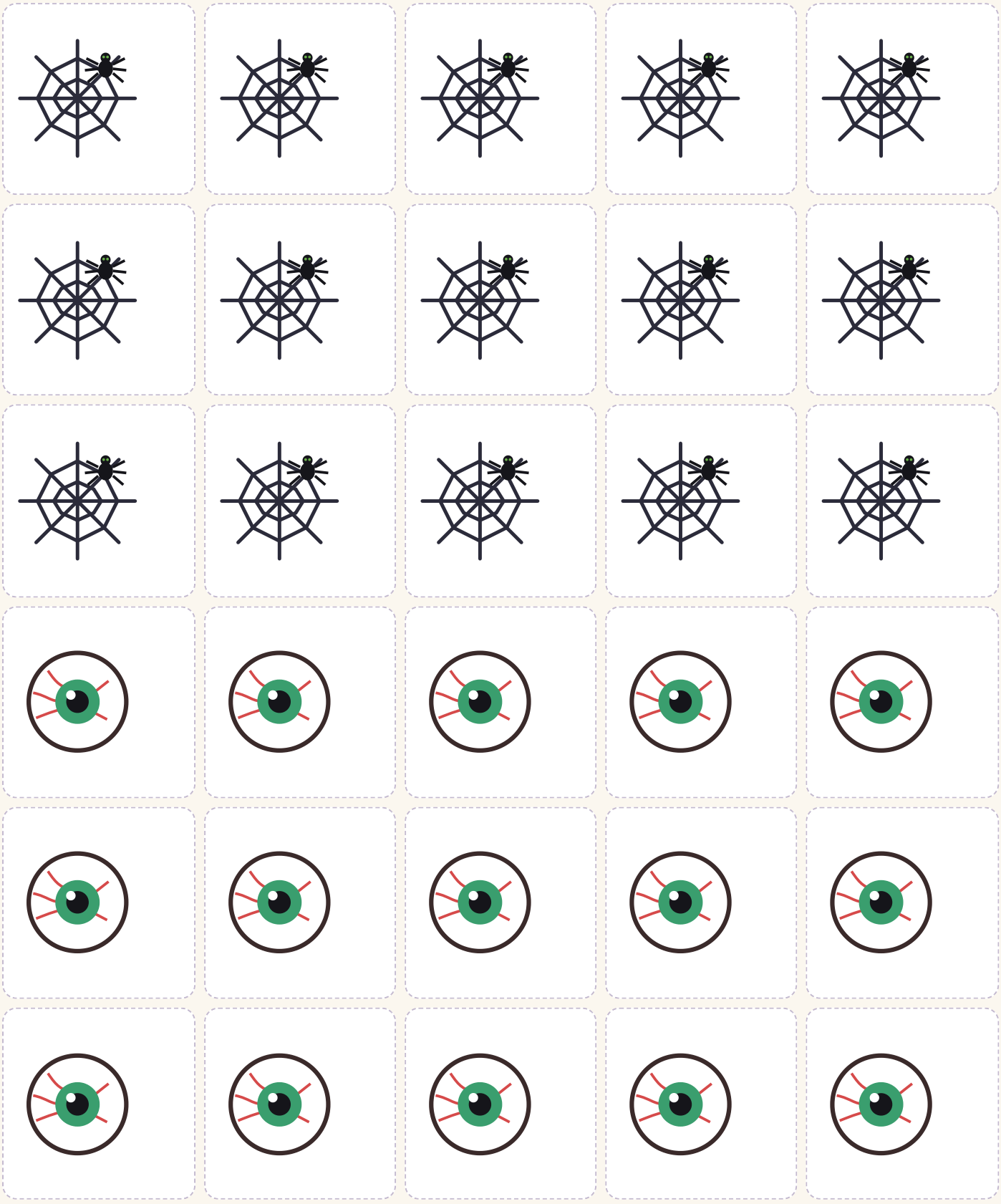
recipe #8



ingredient tokens — webs & eyeballs

cut-out tokens

Print 1–2 copies for a small group.



print on card, laminate, and cut along the dotted lines

ingredient tokens — maggots & pumpkins

cut-out tokens

Print 1–2 copies for a small group.

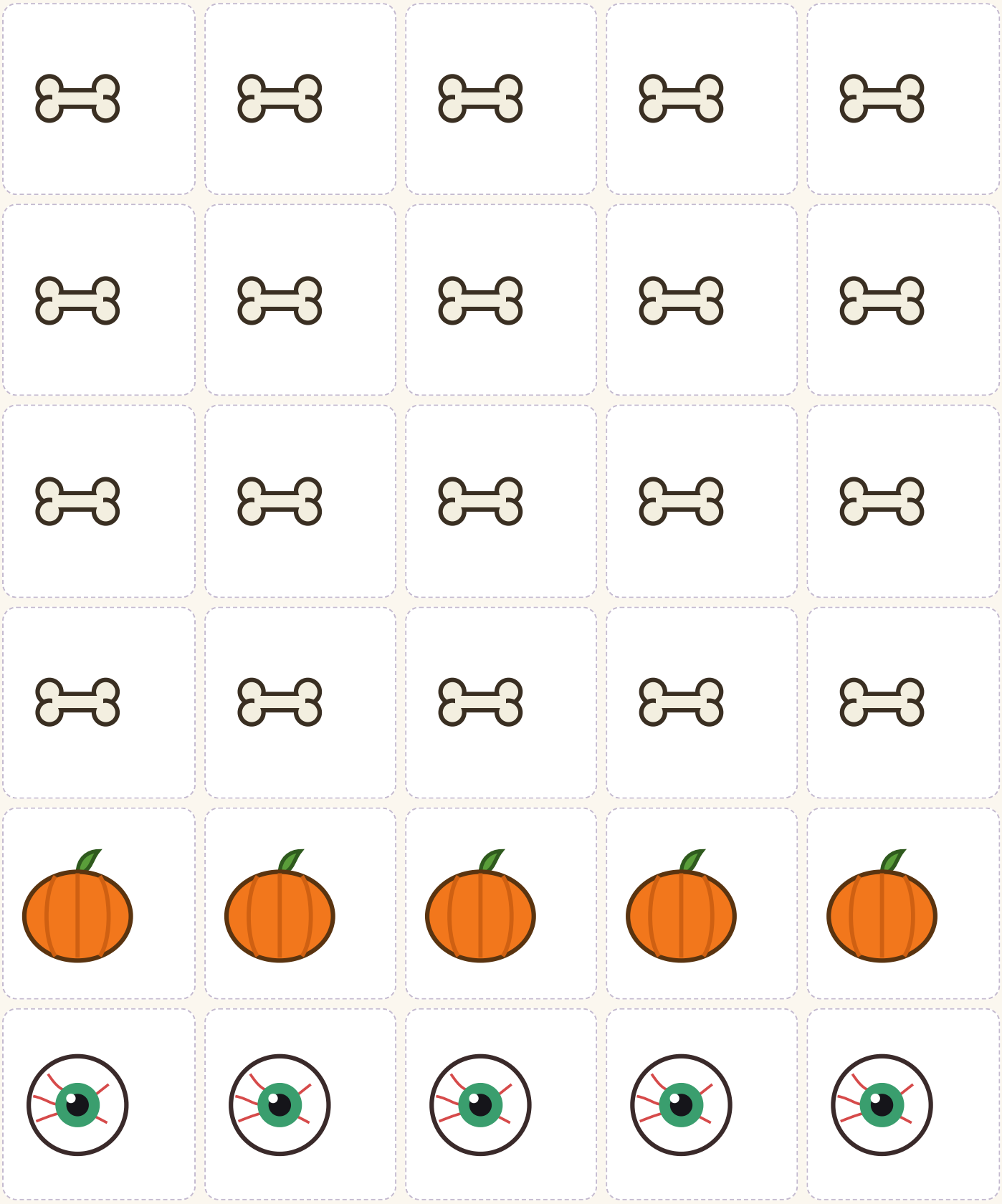


print on card, laminate, and cut along the dotted lines

ingredient tokens — bones (level 2) & extras

cut-out tokens

Bones are used in level 2 (numbers to 10).



print on card, laminate, and cut along the dotted lines